

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET B — ADVANCED HOTS & ANALYTICAL THINKING****CHAPTER 01: UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL SCIENCE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-B-01

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET B - Advanced HOTS & Analytical Thinking):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS) Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed to test **deep causal reasoning, critical source evaluation, constitutional mechanics, and economic analysis**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **ADVANCED HOTS INSTRUCTIONS:** Carefully analyze the socio-historical contexts, geomorphic cause-and-effect relationships, and constitutional principles before selecting your answer.

Q.1 Why is history classified as an analytical social science rather than merely a chronological narrative of past occurrences?

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|---|---|
| (A) It investigates the underlying socio-economic causes, ideological motivations, and long-term impacts of past developments | (B) It strictly relies on royal court mythologies without critical verification |
| (C) It avoids analyzing any material archaeological evidence | (D) It focuses solely on memorizing genealogies and coronation years |

Q.2 An epigraphist encounters a royal copper-plate charter from 800 CE granting tax-free land to a temple. Which critical inquiry must the researcher make to evaluate its historical reliability?

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| (A) Assess whether the charter reflects royal propaganda, verify the authenticity of the seal, and corroborate it with land records and other contemporary epigraphs | (B) Assume the document is completely fictional because copper was rare in ancient times |
| (C) Accept every claim of divine royal descent as literal biological fact | (D) Discard the inscription if it does not mention modern industrial machinery |

Q.3 How does the discovery of Roman gold coins (denarii) in large hoards along the Malabar and Coromandel coasts of India fundamentally alter our understanding of ancient Indian economic history?

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| (A) It proves that ancient India had a thriving, monetized maritime export trade with the Roman Empire, resulting in a favorable balance of trade | (B) It proves that Rome militarily conquered and ruled southern India as a direct colony |
| (C) It indicates that ancient Indians did not know how to mine their own metals | (D) It shows that ancient maritime merchants only engaged in direct non-monetary barter |

Q.4 A researcher studies modern urban traffic congestion by combining GIS satellite mapping (Geography), toll booth pricing data (Economics), city municipal bylaws (Political Science), and historical settlement patterns (History). This exemplifies:

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| (A) An interdisciplinary research methodology | (B) A violation of disciplinary purity |
| (C) A purely theoretical philosophical speculation | (D) An exclusively biological laboratory test |

Q.5 Why is radiocarbon (^{14}C) dating ineffective for dating stone tools like flint hand-axes or quartzite scrapers?

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| (A) Radiocarbon dating measures the radioactive decay of carbon isotopes, which is only present in once-living organic matter | (B) Stone tools contain too much radioactive uranium to be measured |
| (C) Stone tools were created after the invention of modern machinery | (D) Carbon isotopes decay within 24 hours of tool manufacture |

Q.6 What is the critical analytical difference between 'correlation' and 'causation' in social science research?

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| (A) Correlation shows two variables changing together, whereas causation proves that a change in one directly produces the change in the other | (B) Correlation applies only to physical sciences, while causation applies only to literature |
| (C) Correlation proves direct physical force, while causation is purely accidental | (D) There is no distinction; both terms denote identical phenomena |

Q.7 When analyzing court chronicles like Abul Fazl's *Akbarnama* or Megasthenes's *Indica*, why must a historian exercise caution regarding 'courtly perspective'?

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| (A) Court chronicles were authored under royal patronage and may eulogize the monarch while minimizing public hardship and dissent | (B) Ancient court writers were legally forbidden from observing state ceremonies |
| (C) Court documents were written exclusively in undecipherable musical notations | (D) Monarchs never allowed scribes to live within royal capital cities |

Q.8 Consider a case where an archaeologist excavates an ancient cemetery and observes that 5% of graves contain gold ornaments and lapis lazuli beads, while 95% contain simple clay pots. What sociological inference is warranted?

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| (A) The society was characterized by socio-economic stratification and unequal distribution of wealth | (B) The society was completely egalitarian with identical wealth distribution |
| (C) All inhabitants of the settlement died of an infectious epidemic simultaneously | (D) The community had no knowledge of metallurgy or craftsmanship |

Q.9 How does environmental determinism differ from possibilism in human geography?

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| (A) Determinism claims the physical environment strictly dictates human societal forms, while possibilism argues humans creatively adapt and choose within environmental limits | (B) Determinism studies only planets, while possibilism studies only oceanic fish |
| (C) Determinism argues technology controls the climate, while possibilism denies the existence of landforms | (D) There is no difference; both argue climate has zero influence on human settlement |

Q.10 Which ethical guideline is paramount when an anthropologist conducts field research among indigenous tribal communities?

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| (A) Obtaining informed consent, respecting indigenous customary rights, and accurately representing community voices without paternalism | (B) Imposing outside cultural standards by force on the community |
| (C) Publishing sacred secret rituals for commercial profit without permission | (D) Confiscating community sacred artifacts for personal auction |

Q.11 Why is the preservation of folk songs, oral ballads, and vernacular oral histories essential for writing democratic history?

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| (A) They record the perspectives, struggles, and worldviews of subaltern and non-literate communities excluded from elite written archives | (B) They replace the need for physical geography and archaeological excavations |
| (C) Oral ballads are always composed by ruling monarchs | (D) They provide exact mathematical census figures for ancient centuries |

Q.12 An economist observes that construction of a new multi-lane expressway increases land values but displaces 2,000 agrarian tenant farmers. Which social science question does this raise?

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|---|---|
| (A) The ethical and economic conflict between aggregate infrastructural growth and equitable social justice | (B) The chemical reaction between bitumen and rainwater |
| (C) The speed of light in vacuum across paved roads | (D) The geological age of tectonic granite |

Q.13 In scientific historiography, what is 'presentism'?

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| (A) The cognitive fallacy of judging past historical actions and societies exclusively by modern 21st-century values and assumptions | (B) The practice of offering gifts to visiting foreign diplomats |
| (C) The systematic excavation of current architectural sites | (D) The exclusive study of modern history while ignoring the past |

Q.14 How does a population pyramid with a very broad base and sharply tapering top characterize a society's demographic structure?

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| (A) High birth rate combined with high infant/child mortality, resulting in a young dependent population | (B) A rapidly aging population with low fertility and low mortality |
| (C) A completely stable population with zero population growth | (D) A society composed exclusively of senior citizens over 80 years |

Q.15 Which of the following research problems requires a qualitative rather than a quantitative social research methodology?

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| (A) Understanding how migrant workers emotionally experience marginalization and cultural alienation in a metropolitan slum | (B) Measuring the gross state domestic product in Indian Rupees |
| (C) Calculating the infant mortality rate per 1,000 live births | (D) Tabulating the voter turnout percentage in a national parliamentary election |

Q.16 What role does the concept of 'civic agency' play in modern democratic political science?

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| (A) It emphasizes that citizens are active co-creators of public policy, democratic accountability, and community welfare rather than passive subjects | (B) It asserts that only appointed police officers hold civic power |
| (C) It claims that voting is the only permissible activity in a democracy | (D) It suggests citizens should never organize collective social movements |

Q.17 When a geographer uses remote sensing satellite data alongside ground truth surveys, what analytical advantage is achieved?

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| (A) Large-scale macro spatial patterns are accurately verified and calibrated by micro-level field observations | (B) The need to visit the study area is completely eliminated forever |
| (C) Historical texts written in ancient languages are instantly translated | (D) Weather forecasts become 100% infallible for the next fifty years |

Q.18 Why does a critical social scientist avoid viewing culture as a static, unchanging relic of the past?

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| (A) Because human culture is continuously renegotiated, dynamic, and evolving in response to socio-economic and technological exchanges | (B) Because ancient cultures left behind no physical material artifacts |
| (C) Because cultural practices are mandated entirely by genetic biology | (D) Because cultural studies are prohibited in modern universities |

Q.19 Two historians examine the same treaty signed in 1765 and arrive at differing conclusions regarding its fairness. What does this demonstrate about social science knowledge?

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| (A) Social scientific evidence involves interpretive frameworks that can generate multiple valid historiographical viewpoints | (B) One of the historians must be illiterate |
| (C) History has no factual foundation and is purely fictional storytelling | (D) Historical documents cannot be preserved for more than fifty years |

Q.20 Why is the study of institutional checks and balances central to democratic governance?

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| (A) To prevent any single branch of government (Legislature, Executive, Judiciary) from usurping absolute, tyrannical power | (B) To ensure that laws are never enacted or updated |
| (C) To transfer all administrative authority to corporate monopolies | (D) To abolish regular elections in favor of perpetual military tribunals |

Q.21 A developmental policy fails because policymakers ignored local caste dynamics and community water-sharing traditions. This failure underscores the danger of:

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| (A) Technocratic policymaking detached from ground-level sociological realities | (B) Relying too heavily on anthropological fieldwork |
| (C) Investing too much money in primary schools | (D) Providing clean drinking water to villages |

Q.22 What analytical insight does the economic concept of 'externalities' contribute to public decision-making?

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| (A) It reveals uncompensated side effects (such as chemical pollution or traffic congestion) imposed on third parties not reflected in market prices | (B) It calculates the exact profit earned by a private shopkeeper |
| (C) It proves that all factories produce zero environmental pollution | (D) It demonstrates that consumers never buy manufactured goods |

Q.23 An archive contains colonial police logs describing a peasant protest as a 'senseless, violent riot'. How should a critical modern historian analyze this document?

- (A) Recognize the colonial administrative bias in criminalizing dissent, and read 'against the grain' alongside peasant petitions and songs
- (B) Accept the police log as an unbiased, objective summary of the peasants' moral character
- (C) Burn the archival log to erase all traces of colonial governance
- (D) Conclude that peasants had no genuine economic grievances

Q.24 Why is geographic spatial analysis vital for understanding the outbreak of epidemic diseases in urban history?

- (A) It correlates disease hotspots with contaminated water sources, high-density tenement housing, and poor sanitation networks
- (B) It demonstrates that illnesses are caused entirely by celestial planetary alignments
- (C) It eliminates the need for medical science and pharmaceuticals
- (D) It proves that geography has no connection to human health

Q.25 In evaluating whether a national welfare scheme is truly effective, which metric provides the deepest social scientific evaluation?

- (A) Measuring tangible improvements in multi-dimensional human development indices (nutrition, literacy, female autonomy, and household security)
- (B) The volume of glossy promotional advertising posters displayed on highways
- (C) The total number of administrative speeches delivered by ministers
- (D) The weight of paper files generated in bureaucratic offices

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET B)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)	02 (A) (B) (C) (D)	03 (A) (B) (C) (D)	04 (A) (B) (C) (D)	05 (A) (B) (C) (D)
06 (A) (B) (C) (D)	07 (A) (B) (C) (D)	08 (A) (B) (C) (D)	09 (A) (B) (C) (D)	10 (A) (B) (C) (D)
11 (A) (B) (C) (D)	12 (A) (B) (C) (D)	13 (A) (B) (C) (D)	14 (A) (B) (C) (D)	15 (A) (B) (C) (D)
16 (A) (B) (C) (D)	17 (A) (B) (C) (D)	18 (A) (B) (C) (D)	19 (A) (B) (C) (D)	20 (A) (B) (C) (D)
21 (A) (B) (C) (D)	22 (A) (B) (C) (D)	23 (A) (B) (C) (D)	24 (A) (B) (C) (D)	25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET B)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.1	(A)	Analytical history goes beyond 'what happened when' to evaluate causality, socio-economic transformations, conflicting sources, and human agency.
Q.2	(A)	Historical source criticism requires verifying material authenticity, royal ideological intent, donor-beneficiary motives, and cross-referencing with other epigraphs.
Q.3	(A)	Hoardings of Roman aurei and denarii confirm extensive Indo-Roman maritime trade in pepper, textiles, and gemstones, with Pliny lamenting the drain of Roman gold to India.
Q.4	(A)	Interdisciplinary inquiry synthesizes tools from multiple social science fields to diagnose complex multidimensional societal issues.
Q.5	(A)	^{14}C dating depends on organic carbon uptake during life; non-organic minerals and stones lack metabolic carbon and require relative stratigraphy or thermoluminescence.
Q.6	(A)	Identifying that two social trends co-occur (correlation) does not prove that one generated the other (causation), avoiding logical fallacies in policy.
Q.7	(A)	Official court histories frequently served ideological legitimacy and imperial self-fashioning, necessitating critical comparison with non-court records.
Q.8	(A)	Disparities in grave goods (mortuary analysis) reflect institutionalized social stratification and unequal access to prestige resources in ancient societies.
Q.9	(A)	Environmental determinism posits nature as the controlling force, whereas possibilism highlights human technological agency and adaptive choices.
Q.10	(A)	Ethical anthropology mandates informed consent, reciprocity, cultural sensitivity, confidentiality, and protection of indigenous intellectual property.
Q.11	(A)	Subaltern and oral histories democratize historical inquiry by uncovering the lived experiences of women, peasants, artisans, and marginalized groups.
Q.12	(A)	Development economics analyzes the trade-off between macro-level economic growth and localized displacement, equity, and human rights.
Q.13	(A)	Presentism introduces anachronistic bias by evaluating historical figures through modern moral paradigms without grasping their contemporary cultural contexts.
Q.14	(A)	A wide base indicates high birth rates, while a tapering apex reflects high mortality across older cohorts, typical of developing demographics.
Q.15	(A)	Lived psychological experiences, subjective meanings, and social alienation are explored through qualitative interviews and ethnography, not bare numbers.
Q.16	(A)	Civic agency views citizens as conscious participants who organize, deliberate, protest, and shape public institutions beyond passive voting.
Q.17	(A)	Integrating satellite telemetry with ground truthing ensures multi-scalar precision, validating digital signatures against real landscape features.
Q.18	(A)	Culture is fluid, contested, and evolving through dialogue, migration, technological shifts, and internal socio-political contestations.
Q.19	(A)	Historiographical debate reflects diverse analytical frameworks (e.g., Marxist, nationalist, imperialist) interpreting factual evidence through different lenses.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Separation of powers and reciprocal institutional checks prevent the concentration of arbitrary power, preserving constitutional liberties.
Q.21	(A)	Top-down technocratic planning that ignores sociological nuances, caste hierarchies, and customary water norms frequently leads to policy failure.
Q.22	(A)	Externalities highlight market failures where private costs diverge from social costs (e.g., air pollution), justifying public regulation and taxes.
Q.23	(A)	Reading 'against the grain' requires deconstructing administrative terminology to recover the socio-economic grievances masked by state reports.
Q.24	(A)	Spatial epidemiological mapping (as John Snow pioneered in 1854) connects disease transmission vectors with environmental and infrastructural variables.
Q.25	(A)	Substantive policy evaluation relies on empirical multidimensional well-being indicators rather than public relations announcements.